

자다? 차다? 짜다? — ㅈ · ㅊ · ㅉ 소리 익히기

Learn how ㅈ, ㅊ and ㅉ sound at the start of a word. They differ in breath and tension. Use them to pick the right verb in sets like 자다/차다/짜다 and 지다/치다/찌다.



WHAT THIS IS FOR

Beginner learners will tell apart and say word-initial ㅈ (plain), ㅊ (aspirated) and ㅉ (tense), then choose the right word in the sets 자다/차다/짜다 and 지다/치다/찌다.

1 THE LETTERS

LETTER	SOUND	TRACE AND COPY
ㅈ	j (plain): soft and relaxed, with only a little breath Close to the "j" in "jam," but softer. At the start of a word it can sound like a light "ch" with only a little air.	
ㅊ	ch (aspirated): comes with a strong puff of air Close to the "ch" in "church." Push out a clear burst of breath.	
ㅉ	jj (tense): tight, sharp, and with no puff of air No exact English match. Think of the "tch" in "pitch," but tighten your throat and tongue and let out no breath.	

2 NOW THE WORDS

WORD	MEANING	IN USE
자다 <i>jada</i>	to sleep	아기가 자요. The baby is sleeping.
차다 <i>chada</i>	to kick	공을 차요. I kick the ball.
짜다 <i>jjada</i>	to be salty	국이 짜요. The soup is salty.





WORD	MEANING	IN USE
지다 <i>jida</i>	to lose (a game or match)	우리 팀이 졌어요. Our team lost.
치다 <i>chida</i>	to hit; to play (piano, table tennis, tennis, etc.)	피아노를 쳐요. I play the piano.
찌다 <i>jjida</i>	to gain (weight)	살이 찼어요. I gained weight.

3 YOUR TURN

- Choose the right word: 너무 피곤해요. 일찍 (자요 / 차요 / 짜요).
- Choose the right word: 이 김치는 소금이 많아서 좀 (자요 / 차요 / 짜요).
- Choose the right word: 친구와 탁구를 (저요 / 쳐요 / 찌요).
- Choose the right word: 겨울에는 많이 먹어서 살이 (저요 / 쳐요 / 찌요).
- Choose the right word: 동생이 화가 나서 문을 발로 (찼어요 / 찼어요 / 찼어요).
- Choose the right word: 어제 농구 경기에서 2점 차이로 (졌어요 / 졌어요 / 졌어요).
- Hold a tissue in front of your mouth and say 자, 차, 짜. Which one makes the tissue move the most?

ANSWERS

- | | |
|-------|-----------------------------------|
| 1) 자요 | 5) 찼어요 |
| 2) 짜요 | 6) 졌어요 |
| 3) 쳐요 | 7) 차 (차 has a strong puff of air) |
| 4) 찌요 | |

